

10.5 Distribution of Households by Household Type

The total number of households in Sri Lanka is reported to be 6,111,315, with the largest number being nuclear households. The lowest number being composite households. Accordingly, more than 50.0 percent of the total households in Sri Lanka are nuclear households. Furthermore, it is noteworthy that more than 50.0 percent of households in all sectors and districts are nuclear households.

When considering the distribution of household types, nuclear households (58.9%) represent the largest percentage, followed by extended households (29.7%), one-person households (10.5%), and composite households (0.9%), in descending order.

Table 10.2 : Percentage Distribution of the Number and of Households by Sector, District and Household Type, 2024

Sector and District	Total Number of Households	%	Household Type and Percentage							
			One Person	%	Nuclear	%	Extended	%	Composite	%
Sri Lanka	6,111,315	100.0	640,704	10.5	3,598,976	58.9	1,815,522	29.7	56,113	0.9
Sector										
Urban	1,042,557	100.0	110,656	10.6	589,828	56.6	318,886	30.6	23,187	2.2
Estate Urban	3,108	100.0	243	7.8	1,624	52.3	1,225	39.4	16	0.5
Rural	4,827,055	100.0	502,502	10.4	2,878,631	59.6	1,413,593	29.3	32,329	0.7
Estate Rural	238,595	100.0	27,303	11.4	128,893	54.1	81,818	34.3	581	0.2
District										
Colombo	661,822	100.0	69,392	10.5	368,810	55.8	204,760	30.9	18,860	2.8
Gampaha	688,635	100.0	79,204	11.5	378,791	55.0	220,914	32.1	9,726	1.4
Kalutara	352,963	100.0	30,146	8.5	200,277	56.8	119,953	34.0	2,587	0.7
Kandy	397,626	100.0	37,663	9.5	227,856	57.3	128,989	32.4	3,118	0.8
Matale	151,132	100.0	16,281	10.8	88,182	58.3	45,750	30.3	919	0.6
Nuwara Eliya	200,261	100.0	21,435	10.7	111,832	55.9	66,308	33.1	686	0.3
Galle	307,704	100.0	31,145	10.1	179,230	58.2	95,257	31.0	2,072	0.7
Matara	231,946	100.0	21,716	9.4	137,577	59.3	71,010	30.6	1,643	0.7
Hambantota	188,638	100.0	19,492	10.3	120,108	63.7	48,267	25.6	771	0.4
Jaffna	159,753	100.0	17,874	11.2	92,908	58.1	48,086	30.1	885	0.6
Mannar	32,330	100.0	3,031	9.4	21,498	66.4	7,652	23.7	149	0.5
Vavuniya	48,399	100.0	5,449	11.3	31,406	64.8	11,308	23.4	236	0.5
Mullaitivu	34,786	100.0	4,312	12.4	22,643	65.0	7,567	21.8	264	0.8
Kilinochchi	36,734	100.0	3,841	10.5	24,569	66.9	8,159	22.2	165	0.4
Batticaloa	170,262	100.0	16,929	9.9	114,232	67.2	38,690	22.7	411	0.2
Ampara	207,007	100.0	19,615	9.5	139,315	67.3	47,608	23.0	469	0.2
Trincomalee	121,948	100.0	12,293	10.1	83,116	68.1	26,193	21.5	346	0.3
Kurunegala	511,166	100.0	58,765	11.5	288,531	56.5	160,165	31.3	3,705	0.7
Puttalam	234,027	100.0	27,324	11.7	136,416	58.3	68,445	29.2	1,842	0.8
Anuradhapura	275,084	100.0	30,309	11.0	168,779	61.4	74,575	27.1	1,421	0.5
Polonnaruwa	127,385	100.0	13,006	10.2	75,208	59.0	38,588	30.3	583	0.5
Badulla	248,262	100.0	26,616	10.7	152,914	61.6	67,534	27.2	1,198	0.5
Moneragala	151,763	100.0	15,864	10.5	102,353	67.4	32,865	21.7	681	0.4
Ratnapura	327,645	100.0	33,705	10.3	198,226	60.5	93,718	28.6	1,996	0.6
Kegalle	244,037	100.0	25,297	10.4	134,199	54.9	83,161	34.1	1,380	0.6